



# IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 14

## PART 1

*A customer is calling a storage company to inquire about renting a self-storage unit. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.*

**Speaker A:** Good morning, Secure Storage Solutions. Arthur speaking. How can I help you today?

**Speaker B:** Oh, hello. I'd like to book a storage unit, please. I saw your advert online and wanted to check availability.

**Speaker A:** Of course. Let's get some details down first. Can I have your name, please?

**Speaker B:** Yes, it's Sarah Jenkins.

**Speaker A:** Jenkins... Is that J-E-N-K-I-N-S?

**Speaker B:** Yes, that's correct.

**Speaker A:** Perfect. And a contact phone number?

**Speaker B:** It's 0-7-4-5-5-9-1-2-3-0-8.

**Speaker A:** Let me just repeat that back: 0-7-4-5-5-9-1-2-3-0-8.

**Speaker B:** Yes, that's right.

**Speaker A:** Great. What size unit were you thinking of? We have several sizes from small lockers up to large garages.

**Speaker B:** I think the medium-sized one, the twelve square metres, should be enough.

**Speaker A:** Let me check our system... Yes, we have a twelve square metre unit available. Now, standard pricing for that is ninety pounds per month, but we have an autumn promotion running. Wait, sorry, let me check that again... Yes, actually, looking at the current promo, the price is seventy-five pounds a month for the first six months.

**Speaker B:** Oh, that's excellent! Seventy-five pounds is very reasonable.

**Speaker A:** Yes, it's a great saving. And when would you like the rental to start?

**Speaker B:** Well, we are moving house on the twelfth of October, so then... oh, hold on, actually, our removal van is only available on the fourteenth of October. Could we start the lease on that day instead?

**Speaker A:** The fourteenth of October? Yes, that's absolutely fine. We can reserve it from that date.

**Speaker B:** Lovely.

**Speaker A:** And just so we know for our inventory and insurance, what major items will you be storing?

**Speaker B:** Mostly it's boxes of books, plus some old wooden chairs and a table. But the bulk of it is definitely the books.

**Speaker A:** Okay, I will write down books as the primary item. Speaking of insurance, our policy requires all renters to have coverage. We can add our comprehensive insurance to your plan for an extra eight pounds a month, or you can use your own provider.

**Speaker B:** I think I'll go with your insurance, just to make things simpler.

**Speaker A:** Understood. I'll add that to the booking. Also, we offer some assistance on moving day. While we don't provide staff to carry things, we do have a heavy-duty trolley available for free that customers can use to move items from the van to the unit.

**Speaker B:** Oh, that would be incredibly useful! I was worried about carrying everything.

**Speaker A:** It's right by the main gate, so you can grab it whenever you arrive. Now, regarding security, you will need to bring your own padlock to secure the unit door itself. We don't supply those for safety reasons, so please ensure you buy one before you arrive.

**Speaker B:** Okay, I'll buy a sturdy padlock this weekend. What about the gate access card?

**Speaker A:** You can collect your electronic key card from our reception desk on your first day. You'll just need to show some photo ID.

**Speaker B:** Great, I'll make sure to bring my passport. Thanks for your help!

**Speaker A:** You're very welcome. See you on the fourteenth.

*This is the end of Part 1.*

## PART 2

*An organizer is giving a talk to new volunteers at the Greenwood Community Garden. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.*

**Speaker A:** Welcome everyone to the Greenwood Community Garden. It's wonderful to see so many new faces here today. Let me start by giving you a little background about how we got started. The garden was set up five years ago on what used to be an abandoned railway yard. It was an eyesore, full of rubbish. While we do occasionally donate surplus produce to local schools, our main goal from the very beginning was to transform this derelict land into a beautiful, productive green space for everyone in the community to enjoy. Let's talk about membership. Anyone is welcome to join us, regardless of whether you live in Greenwood or in one of the neighboring towns. There is no cost involved—membership is entirely free of charge. In return, we operate on a system where members are allocated their own small, private plot. You can cultivate whatever you wish there, from flowers to vegetables, as long as you keep it tidy. Now, a few important rules to keep the garden running smoothly. Water is a precious resource, and we must use it responsibly. While we do have mains taps available, hosepipes are strictly prohibited to prevent waste. We ask everyone to use watering cans instead, which you can fill from our various rainwater collection tanks located around the perimeter. We also run regular educational workshops. Last month we had a very popular session on organic pest control, and next month we will cover how to prune fruit trees. But this Saturday, we are holding a session on composting techniques, which is perfect for beginners. It starts at ten a.m. and is open to all. Looking ahead, we've got big plans for expanding our facilities. We finished building our wooden tool shed last summer, and we're currently raising funds to establish a raised bee hive area. However, our primary construction project for next winter, once the growing season ends, will be a large greenhouse to help us start seedlings earlier in the spring. Now, if you want to get involved in our general maintenance, we host regular volunteer days. These are held every Sunday morning from nine till noon. You don't need any gardening experience, just enthusiasm! However, for safety reasons, we do require that all volunteers wear sturdy boots. Normal trainers or sandals are not allowed in the working areas, as there are heavy tools and uneven ground. Any excess vegetables that we grow in the communal plots are harvested and sold at the monthly local market. The money we make from these sales doesn't go to waste; all profits are used directly to buy new seeds and organic fertilizer for the upcoming season. Finally, we're not just about hard work; we love to socialize too! Every year, we host an annual barbecue in August. It's a wonderful way to celebrate the mid-summer harvest, share food, and get to know your fellow gardeners. I hope to see you all there. Thank you, and let's go take a look around!



*This is the end of Part 2.*



## PART 3

*Two students, Chloe and Maya, are discussing their presentation on geothermal energy with their tutor, Dr. Harrison. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.*

**Speaker A:** Hello Dr. Harrison, thanks for meeting with us today. We've started planning our presentation on geothermal energy for next week's seminar, but we'd love some feedback on our outline.

**Speaker C:** Hello Chloe, hello Maya. It's a fascinating topic. How has your initial research been going?

**Speaker B:** It's been eye-opening. There's so much more to it than we realized.

**Speaker A:** Yes, I was honestly amazed to learn that the Romans actually used geothermal energy for heating their public baths and homes. I always thought of it as a highly sophisticated, modern invention, but it's actually ancient!

**Speaker C:** That's a great historical point to include. It shows how long humanity has harnessed the earth's natural heat. What aspects of modern geothermal power are you focusing on?

**Speaker B:** Well, we wanted to look at global case studies. Iceland is obviously the classic example, where over ninety percent of homes are heated this way.

**Speaker A:** Yes, but we discussed this and agreed that Iceland's geological setting is so unique because of the highly active volcanic systems right under the surface. It makes drilling much shallower and therefore exceptionally easy compared to almost anywhere else.

**Speaker B:** Exactly, so we can't really use it as a standard model for other countries. We need to explain that geography is the limiting factor.

**Speaker C:** Good critical thinking. Now, make sure you don't paint too perfect a picture. What about the potential downsides?

**Speaker A:** We are looking at the environmental impacts. There are some greenhouse gases released, like hydrogen sulfide, though it's much lower than fossil fuels.

**Speaker C:** That's true, but don't forget to address the seismicity issue as well. In some regions, deep geothermal drilling and water injection have been linked directly to minor earthquakes. It understandably alarms local residents and can halt projects.

**Speaker B:** Oh, that's a crucial point. We will definitely add a section on seismic risks.

**Speaker C:** And how do you plan to kick off the presentation? You need to hook your classmates' attention right away.

**Speaker B:** We initially thought about showing a short video clip of a geyser, but we realized that might take up too much of our ten-minute limit. So, what about starting with a quick interactive quiz to get the audience involved?

**Speaker A:** Oh, I like that! We could ask them to guess how much of the world's energy comes from geothermal sources. It's much more engaging than just reading out statistics.

**Speaker C:** I agree, an interactive start is always effective. I've also had a quick look at your draft slides.

**Speaker B:** What did you think?

**Speaker C:** They look clean, but you've fallen into a common trap. There is still far too much text on each slide. Try to reduce the text and use simple visual aids or diagrams instead, and let your spoken words do the explaining.

**Speaker A:** Okay, we'll edit those down. Let's decide who does what for the final preparation, Maya.

**Speaker B:** Well, for the historical background of geothermal energy, since you found all those great facts about the Romans, Chloe, do you want to handle that slide?

**Speaker A:** Sure, I'd love to present the history. What about the current global capacity statistics?

**Speaker B:** I've already compiled the data for the USA, Kenya, and New Zealand, so I'm happy to take care of that part.

**Speaker A:** Perfect. Now, the slide on environmental impacts and risks. That's a big topic, especially now that we need to include the seismic risks Dr. Harrison mentioned.

**Speaker B:** Why don't we both work on that section? We can divide the points, and both of us can present a portion of it during the seminar.

**Speaker A:** That sounds sensible. It'll keep the presentation balanced. Next is the cost-benefit analysis. Comparing the initial drilling costs with long-term savings.

**Speaker B:** I find the financial side a bit confusing, to be honest. Would you mind taking that one on, Chloe?

**Speaker A:** No problem at all, I've got some good economic sources I can use. And finally, the slide on future technological developments, like enhanced geothermal systems?



**Speaker B:** I've been reading some fascinating papers on deep-well drilling technologies. I'll take that one.

**Speaker A:** Excellent. We've got a solid plan. Thanks so much for your guidance, Dr. Harrison.

**Speaker C:** My pleasure. I look forward to seeing the final presentation next week.

*This is the end of Part 3.*





## PART 4

*A lecturer in ancient history is giving a talk on the engineering and design of Roman aqueducts. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.*

**Speaker A:** Today, we're going to explore one of the most impressive feats of ancient engineering: the Roman aqueduct system. These structures not only transformed the landscape of the Roman Empire but also revolutionized public health and urban planning. To understand their design, we must first look at the physics behind them. Aqueducts did not rely on modern pumps. Instead, they were designed to transport water from distant freshwater springs into urban centers using nothing but gravity. Because of this, engineers had to calculate the descent very precisely over immense distances. If the path was too steep, the rushing water would erode the stone channels; if it was too flat, the water would simply pool and become stagnant. Once the water arrived in the cities, it served various purposes. While we often associate Roman water systems with luxury, their primary role was public utility. Water was directed first to public drinking fountains, then to the famous public baths, and finally, it was channeled to flush out the public latrines, which was crucial for maintaining hygiene in densely populated cities. Only a small fraction was diverted to private homes, and this was heavily taxed. To achieve the precise gradient required, Roman survey engineers used specialized instruments. The most important of these was the chorobates, a wooden bench-like device about six meters long, which used water-filled grooves to measure the slope of the land. A common misconception is that aqueducts were entirely composed of the grand, arched stone bridges we see in photos today. In reality, about eighty percent of the aqueduct channels were actually constructed underground. This was a deliberate design choice, as burying the channels protected the water from contamination, evaporated loss, and potential enemies during times of war. Arched bridges were only constructed when the water channel had to cross a deep valley or river basin, maintaining that steady, downward slope. Let's look at the construction materials. The channels themselves were typically carved from stone, but to prevent water from leaking through the joints, the inside of the channels had to be lined. For this, the Romans developed a highly specialized, waterproof mortar, made by mixing pozzolana ash with lime. This material was incredibly durable, even remaining intact underwater for centuries. Once the water reached a terminal reservoir, known as a castellum, it was distributed throughout the city. For this localized distribution, the Romans used pipes made of lead. While today we know lead is highly toxic, the constant flow of water through these pipes actually minimized lead poisoning because mineral deposits quickly coated the inside of the pipes. To control the flow and volume of water, bronze valves were installed. These heavy devices could be turned to shut off water to specific districts for repairs. Water quality was also a high priority. Before entering the main distribution network, the water passed through large settling tanks. These basins allowed the flow of





water to slow down temporarily, causing heavy debris like sand, clay, and small pebbles to sink to the bottom, ensuring that only clean water entered the city. Finally, maintaining these systems was a monumental task. The main operational challenge was not structural collapse, but rather the constant buildup of mineral deposits on the interior walls of the channels. This scale restricted the water flow over time and had to be chipped away manually by teams of maintenance workers. Despite these challenges, many aqueducts functioned for hundreds of years, and their legacy still shapes modern water engineering today.

*This is the end of Part 4.*

